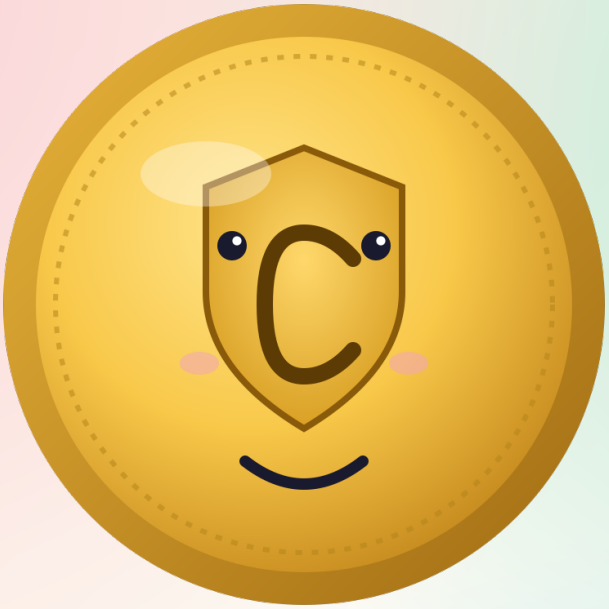


GRADE 2

# Parent Guide

C A S H

Businesses solve problems

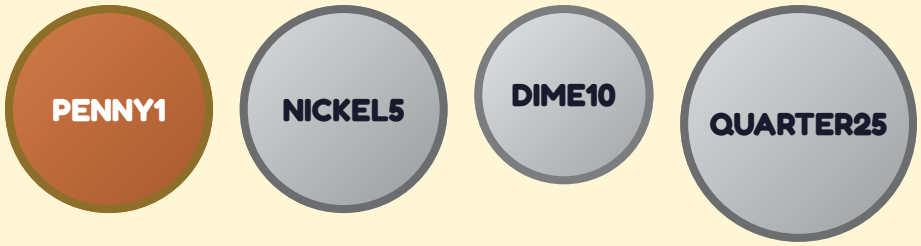
One good question per quarter, family-friendly.

# Grade 2 — Cash to Company: Parent and Caregiver Guide

**A short, warm guide for the adult who lives with a Grade 2 Cash to Company student.**

## What this year is

This year, your second grader is learning that **businesses solve problems.** A spilled juice is a problem; the janitor and the paper towel store both solve it. Lost mittens are a problem; the mitten store solves it. A long lunch line is a problem; the cafeteria can fix it.




We are also teaching three other things, all small and concrete:

- **Make change from a dollar.** If something costs sixty cents, what coins come back? (Forty cents — a quarter, a dime, and a nickel.)
- **Draw a sign that helps a customer.** OPEN. CLOSED. LINE FORMS HERE. TODAY'S SPECIAL.
- **Ask a classmate "what would you change?"** Then write down what they said. We call that **revising.**

The whole year builds toward the **Solve-It Fair** in the final week. Your child will show you a Problem → Idea card, tell you what their classmate said about it, and play one round at a pretend Class Market where they make change for you. You'll be invited.

That is the year. We do not teach pricing or profit. We do not teach business plans. Those come in Grades 3, 4, and 5. This year, we teach the most important habit: see a problem, draw an idea, ask, change.

## What your child is bringing home

You may see:

- A **Problem → Idea card** — a small index card with a problem on top and an idea below. Your child made one in the fall and a better one in the spring.
- A **drawing of a sign** — an OPEN sign, a special sign, a line sign.
- A **change-making page** — coins drawn next to prices.
- A **Solve-It Fair invitation** — usually in May or June.

Your child may say things like "the lunch line is a problem" or "I made forty cents change with a quarter and a dime and a nickel" or "that's not fair to the customer because it's not honest." Those are the year's wins.

**CASH SAYS**

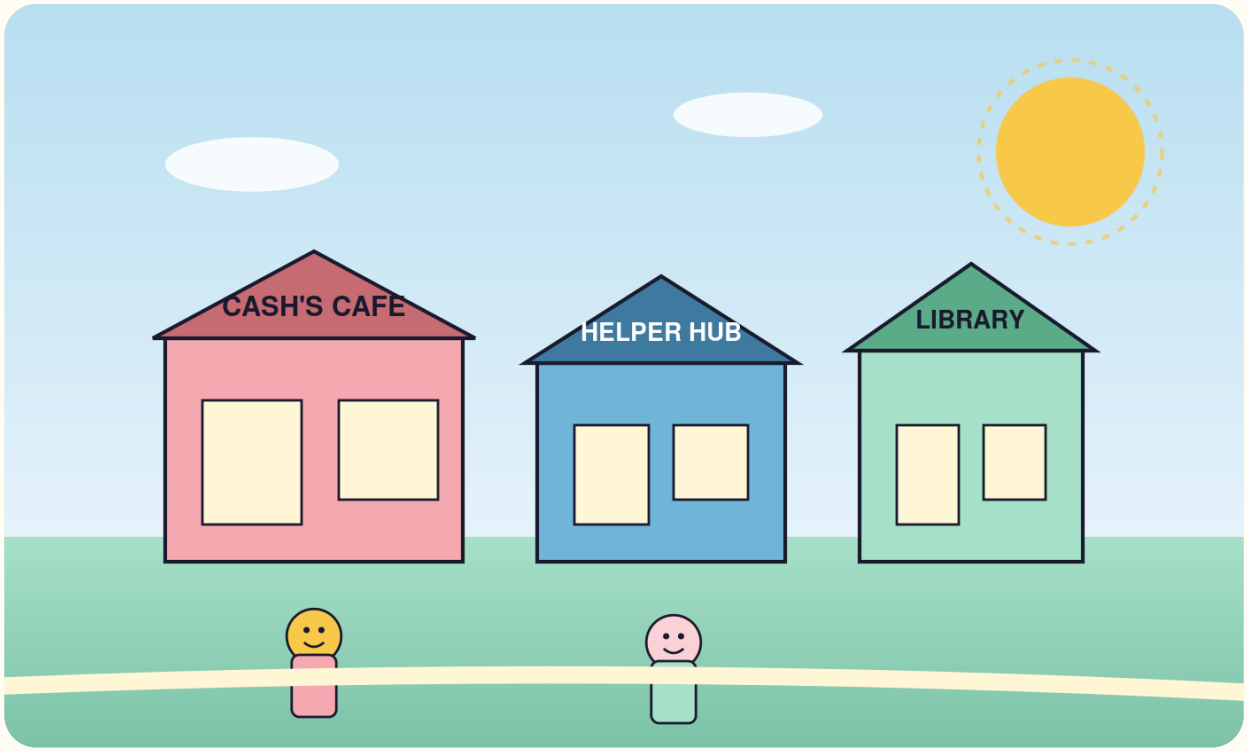
Which coin is more? Show me with your hands.

## What you don't need to do

- **You don't need to teach anything.** A parent with no business background can fully support this year.
- **You don't need to buy anything.** No tools or supplies are required at home.
- **You don't need to share family financial details.** The curriculum will never ask about your family's money. If your child asks something that feels invasive, "that's a grown-up question" is a fine answer.
- **You don't need to fix your child's idea.** Your job is to listen. The point is the noticing and revising, not the idea being "right."

## What you can do (if you want)

These are optional and low-effort. None are required.




Helpers are everywhere. Each one is a kind of business.

## 1. Ask one good question per quarter

Try one of these on a car ride or at dinner. Listen more than you speak.

- **September–October (Unit 1, Problems we see):** "What's a problem you noticed at school today? Who do you think could fix it?"
- **November–January (Unit 2, Coins and change):** "If a snack costs sixty cents and I gave you a dollar, how much change should I get? What coins?"
- **February–April (Unit 3, Signs, teams, and fair play):** "What's a sign you saw today that helped a customer? What did it say?" Or: "Was that fair to the customer? Why?"

- **May–June (Unit 4, The Solve-It Fair):** "What's your Problem → Idea card about this year? What did your classmate say you should change?"

You don't need to know the answers. You're modeling curiosity. Your child will tell you.

## 2. Notice problems together when you're out

When you're at the grocery store, the post office, the dentist, or the library — point at one small problem and one helper for it. "That cart has a wobbly wheel. The cart-fixer is the helper." Or: "Look — they put a 'wet floor' sign up. That sign helps customers not slip." Your child has been doing this all year. They will join in.

## 3. Practice making change in real life (only if natural)

If you're at a café and your child sees the cashier hand back coins, point at it and ask: "How much change did we get?" Or play a quick pretend game at home with a paper dollar and a cup of coins. Once or twice across the year is enough.

## 4. Use the fairness rule at home (gently)

The year's fairness rule is honest, the same for everybody, no tricks. If a sibling argument breaks out about who got more dessert, you can use the rule lightly. Your child will recognize it from school. Don't overuse it.

### 5. Read a picture book together

Any picture book about kids solving problems works — What Do You Do With a Problem?, The Most Magnificent Thing, Those Shoes. Read slowly. Pause. Ask, "what was the problem? What did they do?"

### 6. Come to the Solve-It Fair

In the final week, the class hosts a Solve-It Fair. Your child will show you their Problem → Idea card and make change for you at the pretend Class Market. If you can't come, the school will pair your child with another grown-up. But if you can come — please do.

**CASH SAYS**

What comes first? What comes next?

## What to watch for

- **Your child starts spotting problems out loud.** "That door doesn't close. That's a problem." This is the year working.
- **Your child names "fair" with a real definition.** When they say "that's not fair," you may hear them add a reason — "it's not honest" or "it's not the same for everybody." That's the curriculum.
- **Your child can make change confidently from a dollar by spring.** It will start shaky in November and get smooth by April. Mixed coins for tricky prices (33¢, 47¢) take longer than round prices (75¢, 50¢).

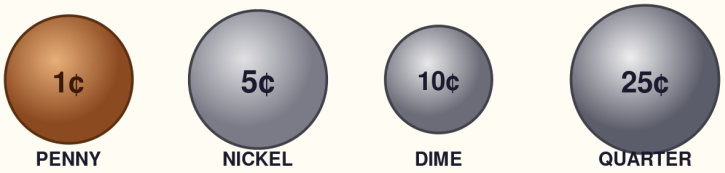
- **Your child wants to play "store" or "fair" at home.** Encourage. Take a turn as the customer. Use kind words. Pay with paper dollars and let your child make change.

## A few honest notes

- **Seven is a real-feelings age.** Some lessons land hard, especially the fairness ones. If your child comes home upset about something they thought was unfair, listen first. Don't rush to "fix" it.
- **This curriculum doesn't promise wealth.** We teach noticing and clarity, not wealth. We say helpers help, problems get solved, and we ask classmates what to change.
- **If something feels wrong for your family,** tell the teacher. Skip the page. Pick a different problem.

**CASH SAYS**

Tell me what they said with their words.




Penny. Nickel. Dime. Quarter. We say each name out loud.

## A short message from Cash

"Hi, family. I'm Cash. Your kid noticed problems all year. They drew ideas. They made change. They asked classmates 'what would you change?' And they listened. That's the year. Thank you for letting me hang out with them. See you in third grade."

If you have questions, your child's teacher is the right person to ask. They have the year's plans, the assessment notes, and the day-to-day picture. They are also a helper. Notice them.

## Senior expert upgrade pack — One-line conversation starters

### "The 30-cent dialogue at the cash register"

When you're paying for a small purchase under $1 with cash:

You: "You want to be the change-maker?" Child: (yes) You: (hand the cashier a dollar; ask the cashier to count the change back to your child)

The cashier counts up: "That's 67 cents. 68, 69, 70 — and 30 makes a dollar. Here's your 33 cents change." Your child watches a real grown-up do the move they practice in school.

(If the cashier doesn't count up, that's fine too — you can do it together at home with the change.)

## Other low-effort questions

- "What's a problem in your school today?" (Bedtime question.)
- "If you could fix one thing in our neighborhood, what would it be?" (Walk-home question.)
- "What sign in this store helps customers the most?" (Errand question.)
- "Was that fair to the customer? How do you know?" (Grocery-line question, when the kid in front of you got bumped.)

**CASH SAYS**

Notice, notice, notice. What did you see?

# ROUND 2 PATCH — Three 30-Second Conversation Starters per Quarter (Grade 2)

**Quarter 1 (Spotting Problems)** 1. On a walk: "Whats one problem you see right now that someone could fix?" — Sample: "The crosswalk is hard to see." — Follow-up: "Who could fix it?" 2. At dinner: "Whats a problem you saw at school today?" — Follow-up: "Could a business help?" 3. In the car: "Why do you think theres a sign here?" — Follow-up: "Whats the problem the sign helps with?"

**Quarter 2 (Make Change from a Dollar)** 1. At checkout: "If this costs 73 cents and we give a dollar, how much do we get back?" — Sample: "27

cents." — Follow-up: "What coins?" 2. At home: "Lets play store. Im selling this for 45 cents and giving you a dollar — make me change." — Follow-up: "How did you do that?" 3. On a walk: "What if a store gave you the wrong change?" — Follow-up: "Should you say something?"

**Quarter 3 (The Solve-It Fair / Honest Helpers)** 1. After school: "What problem did your class try to solve today?" — Follow-up: "Did it work?" 2. Watching a story: "Was the helper in the show fair to the customer?" — Follow-up: "How could you tell?" 3. In the kitchen: "If you ran a snack stand, what would you sell?" — Follow-up: "Whats the price? Whats your cost?"

**Quarter 4 (Asking a Classmate What to Change)** 1. After they finish a project: "Did you ask anyone what theyd change?" — Follow-up: "What did they say?" 2. At bedtime: "Whats one thing youd change about today?" — Follow-up: "Why that one?" 3. Drive-time: "If you could fix one thing in our neighborhood, what would it be?" — Follow-up: "What would the business that fixes it do?"

**Sensitivity:** None of these require parents to share home finances. They work whether your family runs a business or not.

CASH

Which people, and how do you know?

# ROUND 2 PATCH — What Cash Never Says (Parent Reference)

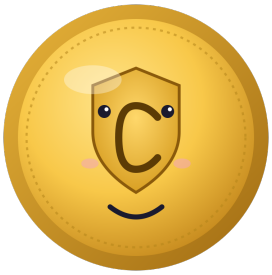
Cash to Companys most distinctive brand promise is the language we dont use. We thought youd want to know.

**Cash will never say to your child:** - "Amazing!" / "Awesome!" — instead, "okay, thats specific — whats the evidence?" - "Everyone can be rich" — Cash promises clearer thinking, not wealth. - "Easy money" / "Passive income" — Cash names hard things directly. - "Just believe in yourself" as a substitute for evidence. - Anything implying money problems are a personal failing.

**Cash always asks instead:** "Which people, and how do you know?" / "What did they actually say?" / "Whats the evidence?"

**Why this matters at home.** Your child will encounter financial-literacy content from many sources, including some that lean hustle-bro or get-rich-quick. The contrast is the point. Cash is on your familys side: clear-eyed, honest, and never selling.

**One question to ask your child this year:** "Did Cash ask you a question this week? What was it?" If your child can name one, the program is landing.



**Which people, and how do you know?**

— CASH

CASH TO COMPANY

# Which people, and how do you know?

Cash is the friendly coin who helps us notice, ask, and try again. Cash will be with us all year. — Grade 2